



What Makes Linux the Preferred Web Hosting Choice?

This article explores the reasons why Linux-based Web hosting solutions are enjoying a larger market share globally, and why they are being hailed as more scalable, flexible and cost effective when compared to proprietary options.

When it comes to desktop operating systems, Windows and Linux have been battling for the front spot for a long time now. The same battle is on in the Web hosting domain too.

Unlike the desktop market, Linux is definitely leading the pack by a wide margin in the Web hosting solutions' space. Before moving on to the reasons that make Linux a popular choice, let's first look at a few statistics that reveal how things are currently placed in the Web hosting OS market.

The Linux dominion

In 2009, Linux's share of the server market ranged between 20 to 40 per cent, based on the number of Linux servers sold by various companies. There has been a considerable growth

in this domain since then. "Currently, Linux is estimated to have acquired about 70 per cent of the server market in India, based on the number of Apache servers in operation," comments P Sridhar Reddy, MD and CEO of Ctrl S. And he believes that Linux will continue to dominate the server market in the coming years as well.

Factors that make Linux a popular choice

Considering the fact that researchers and developers are working incessantly to provide regular upgrades in the Linux and open source space, Linux hosting solutions are considered to be more in sync with the latest technical advancements.

Flavio Andrade, Web hosting manager at Go Daddy agrees with this view: "Because Linux is so popular,